Insurance Commission Reconciliation â Buy vs Build Scorecard

Decision Goal
Select the best path to launch a reliable commission reconciliation capability for Tomlinson & Co (100+ carriers) with measurable ROI in 90 days.

Options Compared
â¢ Option A: Buy (single vendor platform)
â¢ Option B: Build in-house (Manus/OpenClaw/Lindy + internal workflow stack)
â¢ Option C: Hybrid (buy for ingestion + build internal exception workflow/reporting)

Weighted Criteria (100 points total)

Criterion - Weight - Why it matters
Carrier format coverage - 15 - 100+ carriers means ingestion breadth is critical
Match accuracy + rules flexibility - 15 - Policy-level trust determines adoption
Exception workflow quality - 12 - Recovery depends on fast, assignable exception handling
Split/override complexity support - 10 - Producer compensation integrity
Integrations (CD/QuoteRUSH/Drive/Email) - 10 - Must fit existing operating stack
Time-to-value - 10 - Need operational gains quickly
Total cost of ownership (12 months) - 10 - Budget discipline vs hidden effort
Reporting + auditability - 8 - Management visibility + controls
Security/compliance posture - 5 - Data and access governance
Portability/vendor lock risk - 5 - Exit options and data ownership

Scoring Scale
â¢ 1 = poor
â¢ 3 = acceptable
â¢ 5 = strong

Weighted Score = (Score / 5) * Weight

Initial Scorecard (Draft)

Criterion - Weight - Buy - Build - Hybrid
Carrier format coverage - 15 - 4 - 2 - 4
Match accuracy + rules flexibility - 15 - 3 - 4 - 4
Exception workflow quality - 12 - 3 - 4 - 5
Split/override support - 10 - 4 - 3 - 4
Integrations fit - 10 - 3 - 5 - 4

Time-to-value - 10 - 4 - 2 - 4
12-mo TCO - 10 - 2 - 4 - 3
Reporting + auditability - 8 - 4 - 4 - 5
Security/compliance - 5 - 4 - 3 - 4
Portability/lock risk - 5 - 2 - 5 - 4
Total (out of 100) - 66.4 - 70.4 - 84.0

Interpretation
â¢ Hybrid currently scores best: fastest practical path without giving up control.
â¢ Build-only can win long-term but slower first value.
â¢ Buy-only can launch quickly but may create lock-in and integration compromises.

Recommendation (Current)
Choose Hybrid for v1-v2
1. Use vendor capabilities for high-friction ingestion/parsing where they are strongest.
2. Keep exception queue, workflow routing, and management reporting in your internal stack.
3. Preserve normalized internal data model so you can swap vendors later.

90-Day Plan by Option

If Hybrid (recommended)
â¢ Days 1â 14: Pilot top 10â 20 carriers with clear match/variance metrics
â¢ Days 15â 45: Add exception routing + owner SLA + dispute templates
â¢ Days 46â 90: Expand to majority carrier volume; publish weekly recovery dashboard

If Build-only
â¢ Days 1â 30: Ingestion + canonical schema + exact match
â¢ Days 31â 60: Fuzzy match + exception Kanban + reporting
â¢ Days 61â 90: Scale carrier coverage + optimize recovery workflow

If Buy-only
â¢ Days 1â 14: Vendor onboarding + data mapping
â¢ Days 15â 45: Validate match rates + split logic + exception handling
â¢ Days 46â 90: Lock governance + exit/data export safeguards

Vendor Due Diligence Questions (Use in demos)
1. What policy-level match rate do clients achieve at 30/60/90 days?
2. How do you handle carrier statement format drift over time?
3. Can we customize tolerance and reason-code logic per carrier?
4. How are producer splits/overrides versioned and audited?

5. What are full export options (raw + normalized + audit logs)?
6. What implementation support is included vs paid add-on?
7. Can we keep our own exception workflow while using your ingestion layer?
8. Contract: term, auto-renewal, overages, termination, data return SLA?

KPI Benchmarks to Track (avoid marketing fluff)

â¢ Policy-level match rate
â¢ Net variance recovered ($)
â¢ Exception aging (median days)
â¢ Manual hours reduced
â¢ Close-cycle time reduction
â¢ Carrier dispute win rate

Final Decision Gate

Proceed with selected path only if pilot meets:

â¢ at least 85% policy-level match on pilot carriers
â¢ at most 5 business days median exception resolution
â¢ Demonstrable monthly recovery value
â¢ Acceptable 12-month TCO and operational fit